

Product Availability Policy

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1. Purpose and Scope

This policy defines how Harbor & Pine Outfitters describes product availability and how availability questions received by email are answered. Availability answers must be grounded in the current inventory record for the product.

2. Availability Statuses

Every product carries exactly one availability status:

Status Meaning

in_stock Available now; on-hand quantity is above the low-stock threshold.

low_stock Available now, but on-hand quantity is at or below the low-stock threshold.

out_of_stock Temporarily unavailable; a restock date is expected.

backordered Orderable now but not yet in stock; ships on the restock date.

discontinued No longer sold; will not be restocked.

3. On-Hand Quantity and Thresholds

Each product records an on-hand quantity and a low-stock threshold. A product is considered low on stock when its on-hand quantity is greater than zero but at or below its threshold. Exact on-hand quantities are used internally to determine status and are not quoted to customers; customers are told the status only (for example, "in stock" or "low stock"), not the precise count.

4. Restock and Backorder

4.1 Out-of-stock items

An out-of-stock item carries an expected restock date. The customer may be told the expected restock date and invited to order once the item is back in stock.

4.2 Backordered items

A backordered item can be ordered immediately and is expected to ship on its restock date. The customer should be told the expected ship date before ordering.

4.3 Discontinued items

A discontinued item will not be restocked. Where a successor product exists, the customer may be informed of it, but only the existence of a successor that is recorded in the catalogue may be mentioned. No restock date is given for discontinued items.

5. Answering Availability Questions

When a customer asks whether a product is available, the answer must be grounded in the product's current inventory record. Answers follow this pattern:

- in_stock - Confirm the product is available to order now.
- low_stock - Confirm it is available but note that stock is limited.
- out_of_stock - State that it is temporarily unavailable and give the expected restock date.
- backordered - State that it can be ordered now and give the expected ship date.
- discontinued - State that it is no longer available and, if applicable, mention a recorded successor product.

Prices quoted to a customer must match the price recorded in the inventory record.

6. Product Not Found

If the product the customer refers to cannot be matched to a catalogue record, the request is escalated to a human agent under the Customer Service Policy. Availability must never be guessed for a product that is not in the catalogue.

7. Accuracy

Availability statuses reflect the inventory record at the time of the response. A status may change between responses as stock levels move; answers must always be based on the current record rather than a previously cached value.